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Dear Editor,

Please consider our manuscript, “Net-Aware Learned Block Mapping for Reversible Data Hiding in Binary Images,” for publication as a Research Article in the *Journal of Visual Communication and Image Representation*.

The manuscript addresses a practical gap in binary-image reversible data hiding: reported capacity often excludes the side information required for exact extraction and restoration. We introduce a net-aware block-mapping framework combining globally injective distance-one substitutions, CNN-based perceptual ranking, and enumerative coding of the active mapping set, with formal reversibility arguments and wire-level payload accounting.

PPOCP, Huynh–Nguyen, Dong, and the proposed method are evaluated with identical images, messages, payloads, distortion computation, auxiliary-bit accounting, and round-trip checks. On matched BOSSbase images, the proposed method reaches the highest observed net-payload point among the evaluated implementations. Leave-one-image-out validation covers 13,808 held-out candidates, and a separate held-out placement experiment reduces mean DRD from 0.8054 to 0.7663. The study also reports availability, paired inference, runtime, memory, and grouped steganalysis.

The manuscript fits JVCIR through its combination of image representation, perceptual distortion modeling, learned content analysis, and experimental evaluation of reversible visual-data embedding. It establishes net capacity as an auditable quantity and supplies an exactly reversible implementation and reproducibility package.

The manuscript is original, unpublished, and not under consideration elsewhere. All authors approved its submission. We declare no competing interests or external funding; the study involves neither humans nor animals.

Stéphane Gaël R. Ekodeck is the first and corresponding author. The co-authors are Vivien Beyala Kamgang, Serge Alain Ebélé, and Julius Marcellin Nkenlifack.

Thank you for considering our manuscript.

Sincerely,

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